



JOB DESCRIPTION

JOB TITLE:	Public Safety Dispatcher	FLSA:	Non-Exempt
DEPARTMENT:	Police	GRADE:	
REPORTS TO:	Dispatch Supervisor	DATE:	3/1/2021

SUMMARY:

Responds to emergency and non-emergency calls for police, fire and emergency services.

ESSENTIAL FUNCTIONS:

This class specification lists the major duties and requirements of the job and is not all-inclusive. Incumbent(s) may be expected to perform job-related duties other than those contained in this document and may be required to have specific job-related knowledge and skills.

- Answers incoming emergency and non-emergency calls by telephone or radio; uses GPS/GIS systems to track callers and emergency situations; projects positive support of the Department and City organizations at all times.
- Interviews callers and gathers details on complaints; relays pertinent information to law enforcement and emergency services personnel; provides information and assistance to the public.
- Dispatches calls for service to available law enforcement and emergency services personnel.
- Maintains status and awareness of Police patrol units and monitors alarms; tracks the location and activities of all officers on duty.
- Provides detailed call information to officers and emergency services personnel as needed; monitors message traffic and relays important information to officers.
- Performs inquiries and criminal history checks for officers through National Crime Information Center (NCIC), and Alaska Public Safety Information Network (APSIN).
- Monitors fire, panic and burglar alarms for City departments and local businesses.
- Notifies key Department personnel on critical incidents.
- Provides a variety of administrative support duties as required.
- Processes paperwork and records for Police Department, including case reports, court documents, memos, letters, and confidential records; issues licenses and permits.
- Contributes to the efficiency and effectiveness of the unit's service to its customers by offering suggestions and directing or participating as a member of work team.
- Promotes and supports the overall mission of the City by demonstrating courteous and cooperative behavior when interacting with public and staff; acts in a manner that promotes a harmonious and effective workplace environment.

QUALIFICATIONS:

To perform this job successfully, an individual must be able to perform each essential duty satisfactorily. The requirements listed below are representative of the knowledge, skill, and/or ability required.

Education and Experience:

High School diploma/GED; AND two (2) years of administrative support experience; OR an equivalent combination of education, training and experience.

Required Certificates, Licenses, and Registrations:

Continued employment is contingent upon all required licenses and certificates being maintained in active status without suspension or revocation.

- None

Required Knowledge and Skills**Required Knowledge:**

- Police and Fire Departments' standard policies and procedures for dispatching law enforcement officers and other emergency services.
- Operation of common office equipment.
- Policies and procedures related to the department to which assigned.
- Correct English usage, including spelling, grammar, punctuation, and vocabulary.
- Local geographical area, road systems, and the locations of important buildings.
- Operational principles and procedures of IT systems and software related to duties.
- Standard office practices and procedures, including filing and the operation of standard office equipment.
- Records management principles and practices.
- Principles and practices of customer service.

Required Skills:

- Multi-tasking in the performance of duties while maintaining confidentiality of private and sensitive information.
- Performing various cognitive processes, including and not limited to, thinking of a number of ideas or alternatives about a given incident, remembering information pertaining to details of recent incidents, comparing letters, numbers, objects, pictures or patterns quickly and accurately and choosing between two or more sources of information.
- Making sound decisions in accordance with Departmental policies and procedures.
- Communicate effectively in oral and written forms.
- Using IT systems while compiling information over the phone with a law enforcement automated dispatching system.
- Using initiative and independent judgment within established procedural guidelines.
- Using tact, discretion and prudence in working with those contacted in the course of the work.
- Contributing effectively to the accomplishment of team or work unit goals, objectives and activities.
- Establishing and maintaining effective working relationships with a variety of individuals contacted in the course of the work.

PHYSICAL/MENTAL REQUIREMENTS:

The physical demands described herein are representative of those that must be met by an employee to successfully perform the essential functions of the job. Reasonable accommodations may be made to enable individuals with disabilities to perform the essential functions.

Mobility to work in an office setting, use standard office equipment and stamina to sit for extended periods of time; strength to lift and carry up to 10 pounds; vision to read printed materials and computer screens; and hearing and speech to communicate in person or over the telephone.

WORKING ENVIRONMENT:

Work is performed in an office setting.

Work is subject to performance under stress for a continuous periods of time.